

Rich Palmer

Graphic Designer + Digital Designer

Experienced designer. Passionate about creativity, obsessed with the details.
Embracing new technology, trusting traditional principles.

About

I'm a graphic and digital designer based in Nottingham with more than thirty years in the industry. In that time I've worked across pretty much everything: logos, brand identities, brochures, catalogues, advertising campaigns, websites, digital marketing, UX and UI. Clients have ranged from major international brands to the independent shop down the road – and they all get the same level of care.

Right now I'm part of the creative team at Pentland Brands, producing work across their global sports and lifestyle portfolio – Speedo, Berghaus, Ellesse, Canterbury, Kickers, Endura and Mitre. Before that I spent twenty-three years at one studio, growing from graphic designer to lead creative. That's given me a clear view of the industry from every angle: hands-on design, creative direction, client management and everything in between.

I love what I do. Design is the only career I've ever wanted, and I'm still as interested in it now as I was the day I sat down at my first Mac.

What I bring

Reliable delivery

Calm under pressure, easy to work with. I know what good work looks like and how to get it out the door – whether the client is a global brand or a one-person business.

Strong on briefs

I turn briefs into something solid. I'll deliver what's asked for, but I'll push further too – suggesting alternatives and angles the brief didn't consider. When a brief is unclear, I'm good at helping people work out what they actually need.

Fast when it matters

Quick to read a situation and get moving. Working fast doesn't mean cutting corners – it means making smart choices about what matters most.

Creative oversight

Comfortable holding the creative vision across a project, working within teams of any size and keeping output consistent from brief to delivery.

AI and tools

An active user of AI across image, copy and workflow – including Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Adobe Firefly and Figma's built-in AI features. I've built working tools and Figma plugins that improve day-to-day creative workflows.

Experience

Pentland Brands, Nottingham

October 2023 – Present

I joined Pentland's Digital Marketing team in late 2023, and the role has grown into a broader creative position across the business. I now produce work that reaches across the whole company, collaborating with teams in offices around the world.

Day-to-day I create digital and print assets for Pentland's full brand portfolio – Speedo, Berghaus, Mitre, Canterbury, Kickers, Endura and Ellesse. That covers website graphics, marketing campaigns, social content, B2B communications and a wide range of internal projects. Working alongside art directors, producers and visual artists, I help keep output consistent and high quality across every media type we touch.

A core part of the role is meeting the exacting standards of each brand's global Visual Identity. Every brand has its own established look, tone of voice and guidelines, and the work has to sit cleanly inside those frameworks – while still being creative, impactful and worth something in its own right.

I present work directly to stakeholders and brand teams, manage feedback across multiple rounds, and stay close to projects from brief through to sign-off. The earlier I'm involved, the better the end result tends to be.

I've also become an active adopter of AI within the creative team. Selected as one of Pentland's AI Entrepreneurs – a small, handpicked group working to build AI into creative workflows across the business – I've developed a working project management tool using AI, and built a range of practical tools and Figma plugins that improve how the team works day-to-day.

Hullabaloo Visual Communications, Loughborough

January 1999 – September 2022

I joined Hullabaloo as a graphic designer and stayed for twenty-three years, working my way up to lead creative with responsibility for all creative output across the studio, reporting directly to the Managing Director.

The work was enormously varied – brand identities, campaigns, brochures, catalogues, websites, e-marketing, interactive learning tools, animation and exhibition graphics. The client list ranged from major international names including ASSA ABLOY, Yale and Somfy to a long list of smaller local businesses, every one of which got the same level of care and creative thinking.

Over that time I:

- Led the creative direction across hundreds of projects – from quick-turn campaigns to year-long brand rollouts
- Built long-term client relationships, many of whom worked with me for over a decade
- Mentored junior designers and helped shape the studio's creative standards
- Ran pitches and presentations with senior client stakeholders
- Kept adapting as the industry moved from print-led work into digital, web and beyond

The Business Design Agency, Nottingham

January 1998 – December 1998

Short stint working primarily on the ICI Dulux account – campaigns, advertising and product literature. Also where I first got properly hands-on with web design and digital advertising.

Red Rock Design, Beeston, Nottingham

January 1992 – December 1997

Joined as a junior and grew into a senior role over six years. This is where I learned the craft – typography, layout, print production and how to think like a designer.

Remo Print, Beeston, Nottingham December 1987 – December 1991

Print & Desktop Publishing

Started in print and moved into desktop publishing. The first time I sat down in front of an Apple Mac, I knew what I wanted to do for a living.

Software & tools

Design

Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects etc, Figma

Ai tools

Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Adobe Firefly, Figma AI – plus ongoing tool development and Figma plugin builds

Collaboration & support

Monday.com, Trello, Spotify (essential)

Education

Bramcote Hills Comprehensive, Nottingham

1982 – 1987

10 CSE grades

I left school at 16 thinking I wanted to work in the motor trade. Two years as an apprentice at a heavy goods vehicle workshop (with parallel study at Broxtowe College) made it very clear I'd picked the wrong career. Then I sat down in front of an Apple Mac, and everything changed. I'd found something I loved, learned by doing, and haven't looked back since.

Outside of work

I live in Nottingham with my wife Nic and our two kids, who keep me on my toes. I try to be as involved in their lives as possible – and yes, that includes “helping” with their social calendars, which are busier than mine ever was. When I'm not at a screen, I'm usually on a mountain bike, out camping, or in the garage designing and building furniture. I don't sit still for long.

In summary

I've spent my whole working life designing things, and I still love it. I'm always looking to stretch what I can do, and I'll take on a challenge whenever one comes my way. I'm calm, realistic and direct. I get the job done, and I do it with a sense of humour. (Full disclosure: I'm rubbish at small talk.)

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